

This storyline overlooks two key points. You don't have to create a billion-dollar company, or even a million-dollar company to have a successful business and reach FI. It also contains a massive selection bias, focusing on the "unicorn" who made it while ignoring the many others who, despite taking risks, fail anyway.

Hoyt was a success story. He now has months when his website makes several times more than he made in a year as a school teacher. But things could have gone the other way. Investing in your own business can have this type of variability, causing many to shy away. But is the risk of failing reason enough not to try?

Jonathan went all in on the business path, quitting his professional job to focus on *ChooseFI* full-time. Even his partner Brad said he was a bit taken aback when Jonathan informed him of this decision. At the time, their combined business income was not as much as Jonathan was making as a pharmacist.

Jonathan's efficiency with spending enabled him to pay off \$168,000 of student loan debt in four years, and that translated to risk reduction when he started his business. If he still had student loan payments, car payments, and credit card payments due each month, as is common for many taking the standard path through life, his decision would have been much riskier. Throw a small business